

Acula, Ralph Gabriel A.
TedPaths I-9
Understanding The Self

A Path to College Growth

A. Personal Awareness

1. What are my strengths as a learner?

I have thought about this question multiple times, especially for interviews and such, and to simply answer it, I think my strengths lie in my general knowledge and being somewhat knowledgeable in a few things, be it technology, music, etc. Other than that, I'd say my intuition and just not overthinking much, or at least I try not to.

2. What situations make me feel most confident?

I feel confident in situations where I know what I am doing, interested in what I'm doing, and 100% locked in like it's just me and the goal. When the energy's right and the space is right, when these factors align I can feel almost confident in any situation.

3. What values are most important to me?

What I value above all else is staying true to myself, I think there's no one else that can be you, so I presume that I am probably friends with people because they are similar to me in regards to the fact that they are true to themselves. Other than valuing people being real and keeping my circle tight, I also value loyalty that isn't performative, honesty that isn't loud, and respect. At the end of the day, I like to move how I want to move, but I still stay true to people who stay true to me.

4. How do I usually react to stress?

I like to think I perform better under stress than not but when the world is spinning and the ground beneath me really does feel like crumbling I talk to those close to me, my closest friends and closest family members are the most trusted component of my support

system, I react to stress by focusing on things I can actually control, be it my thoughts and actions. And I remember that everything will be okay in the end, if it's not okay then it's not the end.

B. Emotional Intelligence

5. How do I express my feelings in a healthy way?

I try to express my feelings in plenty of ways, most notably by expressing them straight up with no filter. If something is good, then I say it, no need to drag it out. If we are discussing a more creative way of expressing feelings, music would definitely be at the top of my list, from creating a beat layer in my home studio or just vibing out and listening to recent songs that have hit my playlist. Music has been one of the biggest outlets for my feelings. Additionally, writing bars and entendres just gets me pumped, like how writing poems used to make me feel.

6. Can I recognize when others are upset or happy?

When I try to, I can sense when a person is hurt or going through something, the energy of a person or the vibe they bring is really telling. However, I try to think about things in a logical way so I may not bring it up as that could bring some awkward moments, but if I'm up for it or if I like the person or consider them a close enough friend, I'd ask them what's up and if I could help them out.

7. How do I handle conflict with others?

Conflict can be loud, so I try to minimize my interaction with it these days. In the past I would have handled it directly rather than not, I'm not saying I won't handle it directly anymore, but as I've grown, I realize that conflict brings so much noise and static that I'd rather just not fan the fires any bigger and just step back, no theatrics or fluff.

C. Goals and Motivation

8. What motivates me to do my best?

I am motivated when I know my purpose and am surrounded by people whom I value, if I become dependable to my family and friends, I'd feel like I was doing something right. Additionally, I'm motivated by wanting to be free and impactful in the interests that inspire me. Creating a future for myself where I can do all the things I love without worrying about anything extraneous.

9. What are my short-term and long-term goals?

For my short term goals, I just want to focus on me, staying steady, learning some things, but not going overboard with everything. I want to spend time with my friends and friends over this break, as well as getting back into music, boxing, and reading books that I've kept shelved for a long time. As for my long-term goals, there are definitely many that are floating around in my mind right now, one of them is getting into BLiS and getting a license right after graduation, and possibly getting a master's degree. Furthermore, my goals that do not really fit into academics and university are establishing a library or space where I can curate books, archive pieces from different brands, music, and internet culture as a whole.

10. What habits help me stay focused?

Recently, I've felt that I actually haven't been focused or motivated enough when it comes to my academics. I have not been doing well, but I like to think that I'm just adapting and getting into the groove of things especially after an impactful 2 years of senior high. Some habits that help me stay focused are sticking to a routine, not letting the outside noise affect me, and keeping my space clean for focus.

11. What distracts me from achieving my goals?

Sometimes I feel that random thoughts of differing goals distract me from actually working on my goal. Additionally, bad vibes and unproductivity that break the flow distract me.

D. Social Self

12. How do I interact with others in a group?

In groups of people whom I'm not really familiar with or somewhat indifferent to, I just like to float by cooperating and just following. If the group is people I'm familiar with and enjoy being around, I'd stick to them, maybe even be chaotic, just have fun and spend as much time as possible while letting the atmosphere and vibe pick the role I need to play.

13. Do I find it easy to make new friends?

I'd honestly say it depends on the place and time, as I like to keep my circle tight, I do not really see much value in having so many friends to the point the energy doesn't feel genuine. On the other hand, if someone's interests and energy match mine, then it would be easy to keep the connection going. I think it's better to keep a close circle of friends who connect without having to force it.

14. How do I handle criticism or feedback?

Generally, I would try to reflect on it. If I find it to be genuine I absorb it and ignore the rest. I consider criticism from those I spend the most time with or respect heavily to be higher priority as their input is most likely to be genuine, as not all opinion deserves attention.

E. Self-Reflection

15. What have I learned about myself recently?

I have learned recently that I actually value my peace way more than I thought. Additionally, I have further strengthened my idea that I work better alone and like it more, the constant noise from groupwork is just not worth it if I can do the same thing if not better, by myself. And finally, I learned that trust in yourself is enough to break barriers and establish a path for yourself.

16. What is one thing I want to improve about myself?

I want to improve my consistency when it comes to every little thing that I put myself into. I have a lot of different hobbies and interests, and sometimes I find it hard to find the time to actually put some work into them, especially with music. I feel as if I've left it dormant for too long and need to get back into the rhythm of things.

17. How do I define success for myself?

When I can sleep at night knowing I stayed true to myself, have little to no worries, and am succeeding in the lane I inevitably choose.

18. What makes me feel fulfilled?

I feel fulfilled when the work I put in turns into something, from hours spent producing beats to reading books and understanding the world in a different light, hard work doesn't have to become something concrete, but when I feel that something is successful, then do I feel fulfillment.

19. How has the subject Understanding the Self helped my college journey as a future teacher?

This is an interesting question as I'm not really striving to be a teacher but a librarian instead, but other than that, the subject "Understanding the self" has further increased the idea in me that I truly am the most important person or concept to understand. Knowing how you act and why you do such things tells you a lot about yourself. All in all, a quote by Nietzsche speaks to me: *"Man is something that shall be overcome. Man is a rope, tied between beast and overman — a rope over an abyss. What is great in man is that he is a bridge and not an end."*

This is an interesting question as I'm not really striving to be a teacher but a librarian instead, but other than that, the subject "Understanding the self" has further increased the idea in me that I truly am the most important person or concept to understand. Knowing how you act and why you do such things tells you a lot about yourself. All in all, a quote by Nietzsche speaks to me: "Man is something that shall be overcome. Man is a rope, tied between beast and overman — a rope over an abyss. What is great in man is that he is a bridge and not an end."

[Check text](#)
[Clear](#)
8505/10000 characters

[Get Grammarly It's Free →](#)

Acknowledge AI usage with instant citations formatted in MLA, APA, or Chicago style. [Get Grammarly It's free →](#)

0% of this text appears to be AI-generated

Go beyond AI detection

[Get Grammarly It's Free →](#)

English French Spanish German All

that do not really fit into academics and university are establishing a library or space where I can curate books, archive pieces from different brands, music, and internet culture as a whole.

10. What habits help me stay focused?

Recently, I've felt that I actually haven't been focused or motivated enough when it comes to my academics. I have not been doing well, but I like to think that I'm just adapting and getting into the groove of things especially after an impactful 2 years of senior high. Some habits that help me stay focused are sticking to a routine, not letting the outside noise affect me, and keeping my space clean for focus.

11. What distracts me from achieving my goals?

Sometimes I feel that random thoughts of differing goals distract me from actually

0% of text is likely AI

QuillBot

Category	Percentage
AI-generated	0%
Human-written & AI-refined	0%
Human-written	100%